

ANIME

Mushoku Tensei: Jobless Reincarnation

☆☆☆☆☆ | To say Jobless Reincarnation is a controversial anime would be an understatement. The issue lies with the premise of the show, wherein a 30-something otaku bum dies in the real world and is reincarnated in another world. So far, we've got a pretty standard isekai setting. However, things get weird when we find out that he reincarnated as a newborn kid named Rudeus (or Rudy for short), but still keeps his original memories and knowledge intact. So now we've essentially got a 30-something otaku piloting a newborn baby. Middle-aged shut-in otakus are not exactly paragons of virtue, and with the usual otaku anime tropes being carried over, everything is made a lot weirder because



of the confusing age dynamic. We should point out that this anime certainly isn't for younger audiences.

Like most typical isekai MCs who were previously useless otakus or NEETs, in this new world, Rudeus is overpowered with an IQ over 9000 (do their brains only start working in the new world?). Mushoku Tensei tries to portray the MC

breaking out of his previous shell, by showing him overcoming the fears he had in his previous life, such as bullying, refusal to accept help, fear of being out in public etc and using this life as a second chance to redeem himself. While that's actually not a bad message to purvey, the fact that the MC is a massive sleazeball completely undermines all of his actual growth as a person.

Now while there are plenty of questionable actions, and characters in the anime - the MC included - what Mushoku Tensei does extremely well is visuals. The world Studio Bind has created is beautiful, and it's certainly the strongest aspect of the show. The animations of the magic and combat are excellent. And also, the opening song is great and you literally can't skip it because it's baked into each episode, setting up the scene for what's to come.

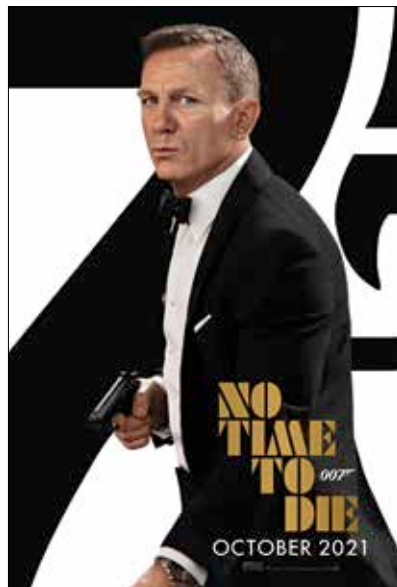
Mushoku Tensei is a weird isekai, but it is well made, which is all it has going for it. The storyline is somewhat(?) intriguing enough to keep you going but we still wouldn't recommend this anime.

—Manish Rajesh

MOVIE

No Time to Die

☆☆☆☆☆ | Daniel Craig's 007 was always a non-conforming portrayal of the Bond that we've all grown up to know. News of his succession as the next Bond after Pierce Brosnan did raise a few eyebrows since he didn't fit the Bond stereotype. Bond was lean, dark-haired, and relied on his charm, gizmos and fighting skills to make quick work of the villains. Daniel Craig in his introduction in Casino Royale proved his mettle and silenced all voices of dissent. However, Quantum of Solace was a huge disappointment and Skyfall brought the series back to the original formula. Unfortunately, Spectre dragged it back into the pits. With this high-and-low cadence of the ratings, one would have hoped that the studio would go the extra mile to make No



Time to Die a better Bond movie. Alas, we were wrong.

There's nothing wrong with the casting, Rami Malek is a good actor but they simply did not devote enough screen time for him to come across as an

arch villain. The writers simply put him in an elaborately designed lair and gave him a couple of loyal henchmen. After all, that's enough to make someone a villain, right? The movie has multiple arcs which seem to jump out of nowhere and are poorly intertwined. You don't need a 00-agent to solve this mystery, Inspector Clouseau with all his ineptitude could have saved the day just as effortlessly.

There's plenty of action, lots of gizmos and a few mini-boss fights but they all seem to be out of place. It's no wonder that Danny Boyle left the movie because it was that obvious that this wasn't a Bond Movie. However, that doesn't make it a bad movie. Even with all the crappy writing, the movie has still lived up to audience expectations and it's a decent one-time-watch. But is it a Bond movie? No. Is the writing good? Not at all. Was it a good send-off for Daniel Craig whose contract ends with this movie? Nope. Was it a ... you get the drift.

—Mithun Mohandas